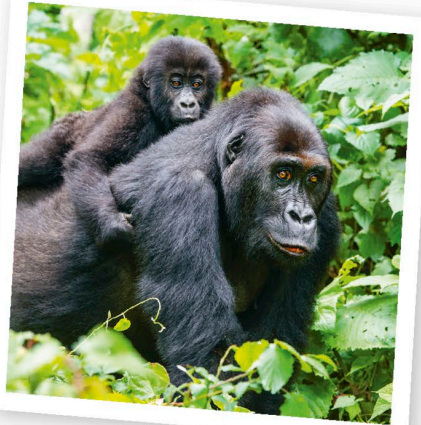


Rain forests

Unlimited moisture and plenty of sunlight mean that trees can grow and grow—and that's exactly what happens in a tropical rain forest. The trees compete frantically with each other for the light, and reach tremendous heights as a result.

Teeming with life

Scientists think that over half of all the plant and animal species in the world, some not yet discovered, live in rain forest habitats. Many are found nowhere else on Earth.



Vital forests

Rain forests produce 20 percent of the oxygen we need to breathe. They also absorb the greenhouse gas carbon dioxide, which helps control climate change and keeps the planet's weather stable.